

10.6 The report

Each student is required to produce a project report. Students should be encouraged to start work on their reports before they have completed their practical work. They should be allowed a further period of at least two to three weeks to produce their reports after they have completed their collection of data. The report must be word processed and submitted electronically.

Students should aim to produce well-organised and clear reports. They should select, organise and present information clearly and logically, present their work appropriately, select and use images to illustrate points clearly, and use standard conventions of spelling, punctuation and grammar. The report should be in the style of a scientific paper. Sub-headings should be used to aid organisation. The initial aim of the project should be stated clearly, as should any overall conclusions that have been drawn. The report should include a bibliography listing all reference sources consulted. Graphs, tables and diagrams should be used where they add to the clarity and conciseness of the report.

The report will be between 2700 and 3300 words, including abstract, trial, tables/captions, appendices and any other text, but excluding the bibliography.

Credit will be given to reports that are clear and concise, show good use of English and appropriate biological terminology.

The investigation is marked out of a total of 45 marks, using the criteria given below.

Intermediate marks (eg 1, 3, 5) should be used when students have partially achieved a listed mark level of the criteria, but half-marks should not be used. Note that for each aspect, the criteria are hierarchical: for a mark to be awarded, all of the earlier mark levels must have been satisfied. A mark of 0 should be awarded if the work submitted is unworthy of any credit.

When a student fails to submit work by the due date specified by the centre, this should be indicated by recording A (for absence) in the mark record. Where more than one teacher has been involved in internal assessment of students, centres must make arrangements for internal moderation to be carried out, and details of this procedure must be available for the moderator if requested.

It is the responsibility of the teacher to ensure that the report submitted from each student is produced individually. In submitting the authentication certificate teachers accept the responsibility for ensuring that these conditions have been met.